

COOEE - Provenance Notes

Spreadsheets

There are four spreadsheets in the COOEE download package (at 2025-06-27):

1. COOEE.xls

This is the most complete description of the corpus. It consists of 14 tabs.

Title	Notes
1788-1900	Lists all content files with Author, Text, Addressee metadata plus basic bibliographic information.
Tables-Corp	Statistical summaries of the corpus
Bibliography	Full bibliographic details for sources
Appendix	Same as 1788-1900 but omits Addressee metadata
Ref-AusE	Details of Text, Addressee and short reference for texts written by Australian born or unknown origin
Ref-AusE-1901	Information as on tab 1788-1900 for extension of corpus to 1925 (not implemented)
Ref-BrE	Information as for Ref-AusE for writers of GB origin
Ref-IrE	Information as for Ref-AusE for writers of Irish origin
Ref-NZE	Information as for Ref-AusE for writers of NZ origin
Ref-SAE	Information as for Ref-AusE for writers of South African origin
Ref-CanE	Information as for Ref-AusE for writers of Canadian origin
Corp-Dat-All	Info as tab 1788-1900 with two extra columns (For CEEA, rest) and 351 extra rows (status not known)
Tables-All	Very similar to Tables-Corp , differences not yet identified
Codifications	Code book for Places, Status, Register and Text Type

2. COOEE contents.xls

Contains three tabs corresponding to **1788-1900**, **Bibliography** and **Codifications** in COOEE.xls

3. COOEE_contents.Xlsx

Identical content to COOEE contents.xls, more recent file format.

4. COOEE_contents_original.xlsx

Identical to 3. (I may be responsible for creating both 3 and 4 and for not removing them from what I passed to PT originally)

Missing files

Three items are listed in unedited spreadsheets (e.g. COOEE contents.xls) for which no files existed:

- 1-042
- 1-056
- 1-057

Bibliographic details from the Contents spreadsheet (including text 1-046 for reasons which will shortly emerge):

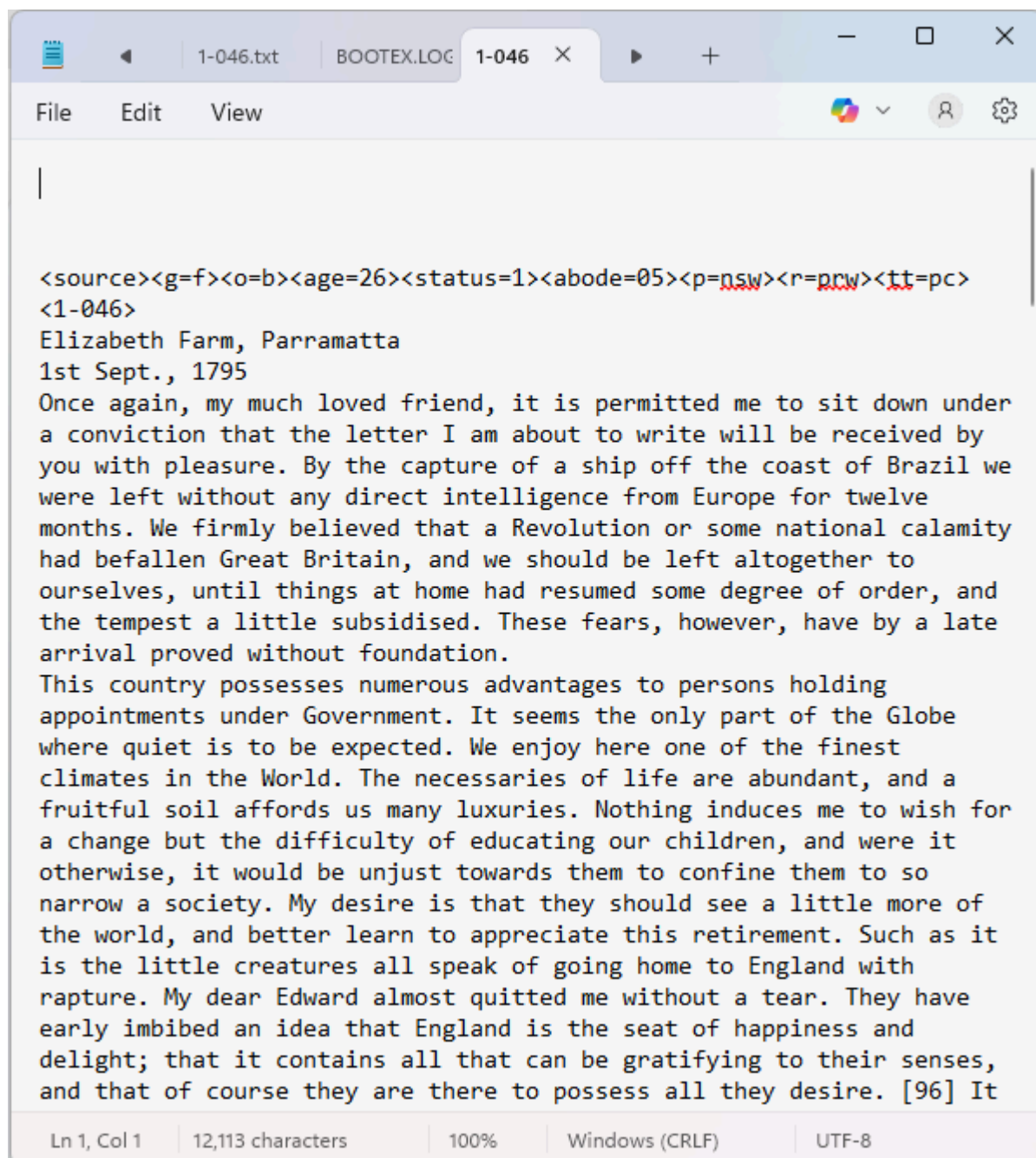
1-0 46	Macarthur, Elizabeth	Webby, 1989	95- 99	Webby, Elizabeth, h,	198 9	Colonial Voices: Letters, Diaries, Journalism and other Accounts of Nineteenth-Centur y Australia,	St. Lucia: University of Queensland Press.
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1-0 42	Macarthur, Elizabeth	Hale, 1950	127 -31	Hale, John,	195 0	Settlers: Being Extracts from the Journals and letters of early colonists in Canada, Australia, South Africa and New Zealand,	London: Faber & Faber.
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1-0 56	Macarthur, Elizabeth	Clarke, 1992	25- 27	Clarke, Patricia and Dale Spender ,	199 2	Life Lines: Australian Women's Letters and Diaries 1788 to 1840,	St Leonards: Allen & Unwin.
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1-0 57	Macarthur, Elizabeth	Niall, 1998	15- 18	Niall, Brendan and John Thomps on,	199 8	The Oxford Book of Australian Letters,	Melbourne: Oxford UP.
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This is the top of the file which does exist (1-046)



The screenshot shows a text editor window with the following content:

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<source><g=f><o=b><age=26><status=1><abode=05><p=nsu><r=prw><tt=pc>
<1-046>
Elizabeth Farm, Parramatta
1st Sept., 1795
Once again, my much loved friend, it is permitted me to sit down under
a conviction that the letter I am about to write will be received by
you with pleasure. By the capture of a ship off the coast of Brazil we
were left without any direct intelligence from Europe for twelve
months. We firmly believed that a Revolution or some national calamity
had befallen Great Britain, and we should be left altogether to
ourselves, until things at home had resumed some degree of order, and
the tempest a little subsidised. These fears, however, have by a late
arrival proved without foundation.
This country possesses numerous advantages to persons holding
appointments under Government. It seems the only part of the Globe
where quiet is to be expected. We enjoy here one of the finest
climates in the World. The necessities of life are abundant, and a
fruitful soil affords us many luxuries. Nothing induces me to wish for
a change but the difficulty of educating our children, and were it
otherwise, it would be unjust towards them to confine them to so
narrow a society. My desire is that they should see a little more of
the world, and better learn to appreciate this retirement. Such as it
is the little creatures all speak of going home to England with
rapture. My dear Edward almost quitted me without a tear. They have
early imbibed an idea that England is the seat of happiness and
delight; that it contains all that can be gratifying to their senses,
and that of course they are there to possess all they desire. [96] It
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Ln 1, Col 1 | 12,113 characters | 100% | Windows (CRLF) | UTF-8

This is the listed source for that text (Webby 1989):

Elizabeth Macarthur

LETTER TO ELIZA KINGDON

Elizabeth Farm, Parramatta

1st Sept., 1795

Once again, my much loved friend, it is permitted me to sit down under a conviction that the letter I am about to write will be received by you with pleasure. By the capture of a ship off the coast of Brazil we were left without any direct intelligence from Europe for twelve months. We firmly believed that a Revolution or some national calamity had befallen Great Britain, and we should be left altogether to ourselves, until things at home had resumed some degree of order, and the tempest a little subsidised. These fears, however, have by a late arrival proved without foundation.

This country possesses numerous advantages to persons holding appointments under Government. It seems the only part of the Globe where quiet is to be expected. We enjoy here one of the finest climates in the World. The necessaries of life are abundant, and a fruitful soil affords us many luxuries. Nothing induces me to wish for a change but the difficulty of educating our children, and were it otherwise, it would be unjust towards them to confine them to so narrow a society. My desire is that they should see a little more of the world, and better learn to appreciate this retirement. Such as it is the little creatures all speak of going home to England with rapture. My dear Edward almost quitted me without a tear. They have early imbibed an idea that England is the seat of happiness and delight; that it contains all that can be gratifying to their senses, and that of

This is the source listed for 1-042 (Hale 1950)::

as they returned to this place you may believe an universal solicitude prevailed, as the danger of the wound could by no means be ascertained until the spear was extracted, and this was not done before his Excellency had caused some papers to be arranged lest the consequences might prove fatal, which happily it did not, for on drawing out the spear, it was found that no vital part had been touched. The Governor, having a good habit of bodily health, the wound perfectly healed in the course of a few weeks. Since then a convict game keeper has been killed by a spear, but it seems in some measure to have been owing to his own imprudence. Bannylong came many times to see the Governor during his confinement, and expressed great sorrow, but the reason why the mischief was done could not be learnt, since that period the natives visit us every day, more or less.

My spirits are at this time low, very low, to-morrow we lose some valuable members of our small society and some very good friends. In so small a society we sensibly feel the loss of every member, more particularly those that are endeared to us by acts of kindness and friendship. From this circumstance and my former letters you may be led to question my happiness, but this much I can with truth add for myself, that since I have had the powers of reason and reflection I never was more sincerely happy than at this time. It is true I have some wishes unaccomplished, but when I consider this is not a state of perfection I am abundantly content.

Elizabeth Farm, Parramatta, 1st Sept., 1795. By the capture of a ship off the coast of Brazil we were left without any direct intelligence from Europe for twelve months. We firmly believed that a Revolution or some national calamity had befallen Great Britain, and we should be left altogether to ourselves, until things at home had resumed some degree of order, and the tempest a little subsided. These fears, however, have by a late arrival proved without foundation.

This country possesses numerous advantages to persons holding appointments under Government. It seems the only part of the Globe where quiet is to be expected. We enjoy here one of the

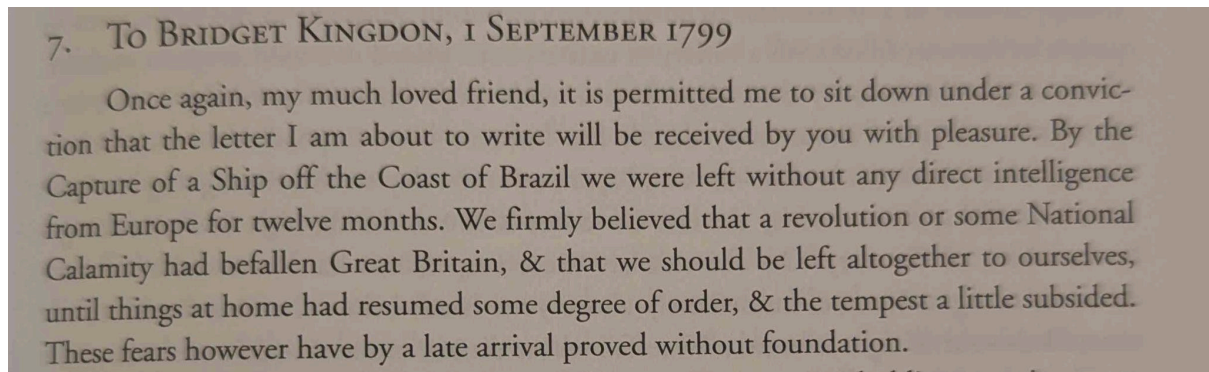
[127]

This is the source listed for 1-056 (Clark & Spender 1992):

When she wrote to her friend Bridget Kingdon in 1798,¹⁰ Elizabeth reported the great success of the Macarthurs' thriving farming enterprises, with her own involvement in the running of the farm obvious. Her letter contains a valuable record of the economic system operating in New South Wales and the use of convict labour—not matters that women generally were thought to be interested in. But Elizabeth Macarthur was vitally interested, and she assumed her correspondent would be also. The only worry she expresses in the letter concerns the education of her children, by then numbering five.

This Country possesses numerous advantages to persons holding appointments under Government; It seems the only part of the Globe where quiet is to be expected—We enjoy here one of the finest Climates in the world—The necessaries of life are abundant, & a fruitful soil affords us many luxuries. Nothing induces me to wish for a change but the difficulty of educating our children, & were it otherwise it would be unjust towards them to confine them to so narrow a society. My desire is that they may see a little more of the world, & better learn to appreciate this retirement . . .

This is the source listed for 1-057 (Niall & Thompson 1998):



My hypothesis is that Clemens Fritz originally took the text from each source, later realised that he had duplicates and deleted the texts but not the entries in the spreadsheet.

Incidental but intriguing details:

Two sources name the recipient of the letter as *Bridget Kingdon*, one has *Eliza Kingdon* and the other a non-committal *Miss Kingdon*. An immediate source for the text is a transcription made by Elizabeth's son Edward, held by the State Library of NSW. The opening salutation is not included, but the catalogue information includes the following: 'Extracts of letters from Elizabeth Macarthur to her goddaughter Eliza Kingdon' and I think we can take Edward Macarthur as a reliable witness on this point. Also, Webby dates the letter as 1795 which -046 and 1-042 follow, Clark & Spender have 1798 and Niall & Thompson have 1799. I think that this is evidence that the Edward Macarthur transcription is the source for at least some of the publications - if you look at the image below, you will see that the year is not clear. Personally, I can get 1795 or 1798, but struggle to read it as 1799.

we have all enjoyed good health & spirits. Edward has become a very fine strong Boy.

Elizabeth Luron Panamatta

September 14th 1798

Once again my much loved friend, it is permitted me to sit down under a conviction that the letter I am about to write will be received by you with pleasure. By the capture of a ship off the Coast of Brazil we were left without any direct intelligence from ^{Europe} England for twelve months. We firmly believed that a Revolution or some national calamity had befallen Great Britain, and that we should be left altogether to ourselves, until things at home had resumed some degree of order, and the tempest a little subsided. These fears however have by a late arrival proved without foundation.

This Country possesses numerous advantages to Persons holding appointments under Government; it seems the only part of the globe more quiet is to be expected. We enjoy here one of the finest climates in the world. The necessaries of life are abundant, and a fruitful soil affords